

MASTER SERVICE AGREEMENT & TECHNOLOGY LICENSING CONTRACT

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EFFECTIVE DATE	January 15, 2025
EXPIRY DATE	January 14, 2028 (3-year term)
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PARTIES

SERVICE PROVIDER	CLIENT	GUARANTOR
NexCore Systems Inc. 1200 Innovation Drive, Suite 400 Wilmington, DE 19801 Reg: DE-CORP-2019-0047821 Rep: Adrian Cole, CEO legal@nexcoresystems.com	Meridian Law Group LLP 88 Financial District Plaza, Floor 12 New York, NY 10005 Reg: NY-LLP-2011-0093342 Rep: Priya Weston, Managing Partner contracts@meridianlaw.com	Meridian Global Holdings Inc. 200 Park Avenue New York, NY 10166 Rep: Thomas Reeves, Chairman (Parent Entity Guarantor)

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SECTION 1 — DEFINITIONS & INTERPRETATION

1.1 "Agreement" — means this Master Service Agreement including all Exhibits, Schedules, and Addenda attached hereto or incorporated by reference.

1.2 "Services" — means the software development, AI model deployment, cloud infrastructure management, and technical consulting services described in Exhibit A.

1.3 "Licensed Software" — means NexCore's proprietary AI document intelligence platform, branded as "**NexCore Insight v3.2**," including all updates, patches, and derivative works developed under this Agreement.

1.4 "Confidential Information" — means any non-public technical, financial, legal, or business information disclosed by either party, whether oral or written, including but not limited to source code, client lists, pricing models, and litigation strategies.

1.5 "Deliverable" — means any work product, report, software module, or documentation produced by NexCore under this Agreement.

1.6 "Uptime" — means the percentage of time the Licensed Software is accessible and operational, calculated monthly, excluding scheduled maintenance windows.

1.7 "Breach" — means a material failure by either party to perform its obligations under this Agreement that remains uncured for more than thirty (30) calendar days after written notice.

1.8 "Force Majeure Event" — means any event beyond a party's reasonable control including acts of God, war, pandemic, cyberattacks by state actors, or regulatory action by governmental authority.

SECTION 2 — SCOPE OF SERVICES

2.1 Core Services

NexCore Systems shall provide the following services to Meridian Law Group:

- (a) Deployment and maintenance of NexCore Insight v3.2 on Meridian's private cloud infrastructure hosted on Amazon Web Services (AWS), Region: us-east-1.
- (b) Custom AI model fine-tuning for legal document analysis covering: Master Service Agreements, Non-Disclosure Agreements, Employment Contracts, M&A; Term Sheets, and Regulatory Compliance Filings.
- (c) Integration with Meridian's existing document management system (NetDocuments v6.1) via REST API within sixty (60) days of the Effective Date — **by March 16, 2025**.
- (d) Monthly performance reporting and model accuracy benchmarking, delivered by the 5th business day of each following month.

2.2 Excluded Services

The following are explicitly outside the scope of this Agreement:

- Legal advice or representation of any kind
- Hardware procurement or on-premise server installation
- Third-party software licensing costs
- Cybersecurity penetration testing (governed by separate SOW)

2.3 Change Orders

Any expansion of scope must be documented via a mutually executed Change Order. NexCore reserves the right to decline Change Orders that conflict with its acceptable use policy (Exhibit D).

SECTION 3 — TECHNOLOGY LICENSE GRANT

3.1 License Type

NexCore hereby grants Meridian Law Group a **non-exclusive, non-transferable, revocable license** to use the Licensed Software (NexCore Insight v3.2) solely for Meridian's internal legal operations during the Term.

3.2 License Restrictions

Meridian shall not, directly or indirectly:

- (a) Sublicense, sell, resell, or transfer the Licensed Software to any third party, including Meridian's own clients;
- (b) Reverse engineer, decompile, or disassemble any component of the Licensed Software;
- (c) Use the Licensed Software to build a competing product;
- (d) Exceed the licensed user limit of **two hundred (200) concurrent users** without prior written approval and additional licensing fees.

3.3 License Fee

The annual license fee for NexCore Insight v3.2 is **USD \$480,000** (Four Hundred Eighty Thousand United States Dollars), payable in quarterly installments:

Installment	Due Date	Amount
First	January 15, 2025	USD \$120,000
Second	April 15, 2025	USD \$120,000
Third	July 15, 2025	USD \$120,000
Fourth	October 15, 2025	USD \$120,000

3.4 License Audit

NexCore reserves the right to audit Meridian's usage of the Licensed Software once per calendar year upon thirty (30) days' written notice. Meridian must provide access to usage logs within five (5) business days. Failure to comply constitutes a material Breach.

SECTION 4 — PAYMENT TERMS & INVOICING

4.1 Invoicing

NexCore shall issue invoices fourteen (14) days prior to each payment due date. All invoices are payable within thirty (30) days of issuance.

4.2 Late Payment Penalty

RISK: Invoices not paid within thirty (30) days shall accrue interest at **1.5% per month (18% per annum)** on the outstanding balance. NexCore reserves the right to **suspend Services** if any invoice remains unpaid for sixty (60) or more consecutive days.

4.3 Disputed Invoices

Meridian must notify NexCore of any invoice dispute within ten (10) business days of receipt. Undisputed portions must be paid by the original due date. Disputes must be resolved within forty-five (45) calendar days or escalated to mediation per Section 14.

4.4 Taxes

All fees are exclusive of applicable taxes. Meridian is responsible for all sales, use, VAT, or equivalent taxes unless NexCore is legally required to collect and remit such taxes directly.

4.5 Price Escalation

RISK: NexCore may increase service fees annually by no more than the greater of (i) **5%** or (ii) the U.S. Consumer Price Index (CPI) for the preceding 12-month period, provided ninety (90) days written notice is given.

SECTION 5 — INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS

5.1 NexCore IP

All intellectual property in the Licensed Software, including underlying AI models, training data, algorithms, and documentation, remains the **exclusive property of NexCore Systems Inc.** This Agreement transfers no ownership rights of any kind.

5.2 Meridian Data

All data, documents, and content uploaded by Meridian to the platform ("**Client Data**") remains the exclusive property of Meridian Law Group. NexCore shall not use Client Data for model training, benchmarking, or any purpose outside the Services without Meridian's prior written consent.

5.3 Joint Developments

Any custom features, modules, or AI models developed specifically for Meridian under a Change Order shall be **jointly owned**, with each party holding an equal, undivided interest. Either party may commercialize joint developments without the other's consent, provided confidential information is not disclosed.

5.4 Work for Hire

Deliverables created solely for Meridian under Exhibit A (and not involving NexCore's core platform) shall be deemed "work for hire" and ownership shall vest in Meridian upon full payment of all fees.

SECTION 6 — CONFIDENTIALITY OBLIGATIONS

6.1 Mutual Confidentiality

Each party agrees to maintain the confidentiality of the other party's Confidential Information using at least the same degree of care it uses for its own confidential information, but in no event less than reasonable care.

6.2 Permitted Disclosures

Confidential Information may be disclosed only to employees, contractors, or advisors who (a) have a need to know, and (b) are bound by written confidentiality obligations no less restrictive than this Agreement.

6.3 Duration

Confidentiality obligations survive termination of this Agreement for a period of **five (5) years** from the date of termination or expiry. Obligations with respect to trade secrets shall survive **indefinitely**.

6.4 Exclusions

Confidentiality obligations do not apply to information that: (a) is or becomes publicly available through no fault of the receiving party; (b) was independently developed; (c) is required to be disclosed by law, court order, or regulatory body, provided prompt prior written notice is given.

SECTION 7 — DATA PROTECTION & SECURITY

7.1 Compliance

Both parties shall comply with all applicable data protection laws, including the **California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA)**, the **EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)** where applicable, and the **New York SHIELD Act**.

7.2 Data Processing Agreement

The parties have entered into a separate Data Processing Agreement (DPA), attached as Exhibit C, which governs NexCore's processing of any personal data on behalf of Meridian.

7.3 Security Standards

NexCore shall maintain information security measures consistent with **ISO 27001** standards and shall undergo annual **SOC 2 Type II** audits. Audit reports shall be made available to Meridian upon written request.

7.4 Data Breach Notification

RISK: In the event of a confirmed data breach affecting Meridian's Client Data, NexCore shall notify Meridian within **seventy-two (72) hours** of discovery and provide a full incident report within fifteen (15) business days. Failure to notify within seventy-two (72) hours constitutes a material Breach and may trigger indemnification obligations under Section 10.

7.5 Data Retention & Deletion

Upon termination, NexCore shall securely delete all Client Data within **thirty (30) days** and provide written certification of deletion. Meridian may request a data export in machine-readable format before deletion.

SECTION 8 — SERVICE LEVEL AGREEMENT (SLA)

8.1 Uptime Commitment

NexCore commits to a minimum monthly Uptime of **99.5%** for the Licensed Software, excluding scheduled maintenance windows communicated at least forty-eight (48) hours in advance.

8.2 Scheduled Maintenance

Maintenance windows are limited to Sundays between 02:00 and 06:00 EST. Emergency maintenance may be performed at any time with two (2) hours' notice via email to contracts@meridianlaw.com.

8.3 SLA Credits

Uptime Range	Credit
99.0% – 99.4%	5% credit on monthly fee
98.0% – 98.9%	10% credit on monthly fee
Below 98.0%	20% credit on monthly fee
Maximum aggregate cap	30% of monthly fee per calendar month

8.4 Response Times

Priority	Description	Response	Resolution
Critical	System down	1 hour	4 hours
High	Major feature down	4 hours	24 hours
Medium	Partial impact	8 hours	72 hours
Low	Minor issue	24 hours	5 business days

SECTION 9 — REPRESENTATIONS & WARRANTIES

9.1 NexCore Warrants That:

- (a) The Licensed Software does not infringe any third-party intellectual property rights as of the Effective Date;
- (b) The Services will be performed by qualified professionals in a workmanlike manner consistent with industry standards;
- (c) NexCore has all necessary rights to enter into and perform this Agreement;
- (d) NexCore Insight v3.2 will perform materially as described in the documentation for a **warranty period of ninety (90) days** following deployment.

9.2 Meridian Warrants That:

- (a) Meridian has the right to upload and process all Client Data using the Licensed Software;
- (b) Use of the Services will comply with all applicable laws;
- (c) Meridian's representative (Ms. Priya Weston) has full authority to execute this Agreement on behalf of Meridian Law Group LLP.

9.3 Disclaimer

EXCEPT AS EXPRESSLY SET FORTH IN THIS SECTION, NEXCORE MAKES NO WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY, FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE, OR ACCURACY OF AI-GENERATED OUTPUTS. MERIDIAN ACKNOWLEDGES THAT AI OUTPUTS REQUIRE HUMAN REVIEW BEFORE RELIANCE.

SECTION 10 — INDEMNIFICATION

10.1 NexCore Indemnification

NexCore shall defend, indemnify, and hold harmless Meridian from any third-party claims arising from: (a) infringement of third-party IP by the Licensed Software; (b) NexCore's gross negligence or willful misconduct; (c) data breaches caused by NexCore's failure to maintain security standards under Section 7.

10.2 Meridian Indemnification

Meridian shall indemnify NexCore from claims arising from: (a) Meridian's violation of applicable law; (b) unauthorized modification or misuse of the Licensed Software; (c) claims by Meridian's clients arising from use of AI-generated outputs without appropriate human review.

10.3 Indemnification Procedure

The indemnified party must: (a) promptly notify the indemnifying party in writing; (b) grant the indemnifying party sole control of the defense; (c) cooperate fully at the indemnifying party's expense.

SECTION 11 — LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

11.1 Cap on Liability

RISK — LIABILITY CAP: EACH PARTY'S TOTAL AGGREGATE LIABILITY UNDER THIS AGREEMENT SHALL NOT EXCEED THE TOTAL FEES PAID OR PAYABLE BY MERIDIAN IN THE TWELVE (12) MONTHS IMMEDIATELY PRECEDING THE EVENT GIVING RISE TO LIABILITY.

11.2 Exclusion of Consequential Damages

NEITHER PARTY SHALL BE LIABLE FOR INDIRECT, INCIDENTAL, SPECIAL, PUNITIVE, OR CONSEQUENTIAL DAMAGES, INCLUDING LOST PROFITS, LOSS OF DATA, OR REPUTATIONAL HARM, EVEN IF ADVISED OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGES.

11.3 Exceptions

The limitations in 11.1 and 11.2 shall NOT apply to: (a) breaches of confidentiality; (b) indemnification for IP infringement; (c) damages from gross negligence, fraud, or willful misconduct; (d) death or personal injury caused by negligence.

SECTION 12 — RISK ALLOCATION

12.1 AI Output Risk

RISK: Meridian acknowledges and accepts that AI-generated outputs from NexCore Insight v3.2 may contain errors, omissions, or inaccuracies. Meridian assumes **full responsibility** for any decisions made in reliance on AI outputs without independent legal review. NexCore shall bear no liability for damages arising from unreviewed AI outputs used in client matters.

12.2 Regulatory Risk

RISK: Meridian acknowledges that the regulatory landscape governing AI use in legal practice is evolving. Meridian assumes the risk of any regulatory changes that restrict or prohibit the use of AI tools in legal practice in applicable jurisdictions.

12.3 Third-Party Integration Risk

NexCore is not responsible for failures, data loss, or security incidents arising from the integration with Meridian's third-party systems (including NetDocuments v6.1), unless caused by NexCore's negligent implementation.

12.4 Concentration Risk

RISK: Meridian acknowledges the risk of over-reliance on a single vendor for critical legal AI infrastructure. Meridian is advised to maintain manual backup processes for all mission-critical document review workflows during the Term.

SECTION 13 — TERM, RENEWAL & TERMINATION

13.1 Initial Term

This Agreement commences on **January 15, 2025** and expires on **January 14, 2028**, unless earlier terminated in accordance with this Section.

13.2 Renewal

This Agreement shall automatically renew for successive one (1) year terms unless either party provides written notice of non-renewal at least **ninety (90) days** prior to the end of the then-current term. **First renewal notice deadline: October 16, 2027.**

13.3 Termination for Cause

Either party may terminate immediately upon written notice if the other party: (a) commits a material Breach uncured for thirty (30) days after written notice; (b) becomes insolvent or files for bankruptcy; (c) engages in fraudulent, illegal, or grossly negligent conduct.

13.4 Termination for Convenience

RISK: Meridian may terminate for convenience upon **one hundred and eighty (180) days'** written notice. In such event, Meridian shall remain liable for all fees due through the end of the notice period, plus an **early termination fee equal to twenty-five percent (25%) of the remaining contract value.**

13.5 Effect of Termination

Upon termination: (a) all licenses cease immediately; (b) each party shall return or destroy Confidential Information; (c) NexCore shall provide data export per Section 7.5; (d) all outstanding payment obligations survive termination.

SECTION 14 — DISPUTE RESOLUTION

14.1 Informal Resolution

The parties shall attempt to resolve any dispute through good-faith negotiation for a period of **thirty (30) days** before initiating formal proceedings.

14.2 Mediation

If informal resolution fails, the parties shall submit the dispute to non-binding mediation administered by **JAMS** in New York, NY. Costs of mediation shall be shared equally.

14.3 Binding Arbitration

If mediation fails within sixty (60) days, the dispute shall be finally resolved by binding arbitration under the **JAMS Comprehensive Arbitration Rules**. The arbitration shall be conducted by a single arbitrator in New York, NY. The arbitrator's award shall be final and binding.

14.4 Exception for Injunctive Relief

Nothing in this Section prevents either party from seeking emergency injunctive relief from a court of competent jurisdiction to prevent irreparable harm, including to protect confidential information or intellectual property rights.

SECTION 15 — FORCE MAJEURE

15.1 Neither party shall be liable for delays or failures in performance resulting from Force Majeure Events, provided the affected party: (a) gives prompt written notice within five (5) business days; (b) uses commercially reasonable efforts to mitigate the impact; (c) resumes performance as soon as practicable.

15.2 If a Force Majeure Event continues for more than **ninety (90) consecutive days**, either party may terminate this Agreement without penalty upon thirty (30) days' written notice.

SECTION 16 — GOVERNING LAW & GENERAL PROVISIONS

16.1 Entire Agreement: This Agreement, together with all Exhibits, constitutes the entire agreement between the parties and supersedes all prior negotiations, representations, and agreements.

16.2 Amendments: No amendment to this Agreement is effective unless made in writing and signed by authorized representatives of both parties.

16.3 Severability: If any provision is found unenforceable, it shall be modified to the minimum extent necessary to make it enforceable; all other provisions remain in full force.

16.4 Waiver: Failure to enforce any provision shall not constitute a waiver of the right to enforce it in the future.

16.5 Notices: All formal notices shall be in writing and delivered by: (a) certified mail; (b) overnight courier; or (c) email with confirmed read receipt to the addresses on the cover page.

16.6 Governing Law: This Agreement is governed by the laws of the **State of Delaware**, without regard to its conflict of laws principles.

SECTION 17 — KEY DATES SUMMARY

Event	Date	Section
Effective Date	January 15, 2025	Cover
API Integration Deadline	March 16, 2025	Section 2.1(c)
First Payment Due	January 15, 2025	Section 3.3
Second Payment Due	April 15, 2025	Section 3.3
Third Payment Due	July 15, 2025	Section 3.3
Fourth Payment Due	October 15, 2025	Section 3.3
Year 2 Start	January 15, 2026	Section 13.1
Year 3 Start	January 15, 2027	Section 13.1
Renewal Notice Deadline	October 16, 2027	Section 13.2
Contract Expiry	January 14, 2028	Section 13.1
Warranty Period End	90 days post-deployment	Section 9.1(d)
Data Deletion Post-Term	Within 30 days of termination	Section 7.5
Confidentiality Survival	5 years post-termination	Section 6.3

EXHIBIT A — SERVICE SCHEDULE

Phase 1 — Onboarding (January 15 – March 15, 2025)

- Infrastructure setup on AWS us-east-1
- NexCore Insight v3.2 deployment
- User account provisioning (up to 200 users)
- NetDocuments API integration
- Staff training sessions (4 sessions, 3 hours each)

Phase 2 — Customization (March 16 – June 15, 2025)

- AI model fine-tuning on Meridian's document corpus
- Custom clause library configuration (50 clause types)
- Risk flagging rule configuration
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) with Meridian's team

Phase 3 — Steady State (June 16, 2025 onwards)

- Ongoing model maintenance and updates
- Monthly performance reports
- Quarterly business reviews (QBRs)
- Annual model retraining on updated document corpus

EXHIBIT B — PRICING SCHEDULE

Item	Amount	Notes
Annual License Fee	USD \$480,000	Payable quarterly
Quarterly Installment	USD \$120,000	4 payments per year
Implementation Fee (one-time)	USD \$75,000	Due January 15, 2025
Change Order Rate	USD \$350/hour	Senior engineer rate
Additional User License	USD \$2,400/user/year	Above 200 users
Early Termination Fee	25% of remaining value	Per Section 13.4
Late Payment Interest	1.5% per month	18% per annum
TOTAL CONTRACT VALUE (3 years)	USD \$1,515,000	Excluding Change Orders

EXHIBIT C — DATA PROCESSING AGREEMENT (SUMMARY)

Data Controller	Meridian Law Group LLP
Data Processor	NexCore Systems Inc.
Data Categories	Legal documents, contract text, personal data of parties mentioned in contracts (names, addresses,
Processing Purpose	AI-assisted document analysis and clause extraction
Retention Period	Duration of Agreement + 30 days
Sub-processors	Amazon Web Services (AWS) — infrastructure only
Transfer Mechanism	Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) for any EU personal data
Applicable Laws	CCPA, GDPR (where applicable), New York SHIELD Act

EXHIBIT D — ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY

Prohibited Uses

- Processing documents related to illegal activities
- Attempting to extract, copy, or reverse engineer AI model weights
- Sharing login credentials across users
- Using the platform for any matter involving NexCore as an adverse party
- Uploading documents subject to court-ordered sealing without authorization

EXECUTION PAGE — SIGNATURES

FOR NEXCORE SYSTEMS INC.	FOR MERIDIAN LAW GROUP LLP	FOR MERIDIAN GLOBAL HOLDINGS INC.
Adrian Cole Chief Executive Officer Date: January 15, 2025	Priya Weston Managing Partner Date: January 15, 2025	Thomas Reeves Chairman (Guarantor) Date: January 15, 2025